



free will
and
determinism

against
compatibilist
free will

A red circular button with a slight drop shadow, containing the text "against incompatibilist free will" in white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. No one has any choice about events which happened in the distant past.
 2. No one has any choice about DINOSAUR.
(1)
 3. If determinism is true, then only one future is consistent with the state of the world at a time + the laws of nature.
 4. If determinism is true, then the laws of nature say that if DINOSAUR happens, then DECISION happens. (3)
 5. No one has any choice about what the laws of nature are.
 6. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about the fact that if DINOSAUR then DECISION. (4,5)
 7. If no one has about choice about whether P, and no one has any choice about whether, if P, then Q, then no one has any choice about whether Q.
-

C. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about DECISION. (2,6,7)

This argument seems to show that the combination of four theses — that No one has any choice about the past, no choice about the laws of nature, the no choice principle, and determinism — rules out free will.

Since the first three of these theses seem quite plausible, the argument seems to show that if determinism is true, there are no free actions — and hence that free will is incompatible with determinism.

The consequence argument

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe in free will, and find the consequence argument persuasive, it looks tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

But, we'll see now, this argument can also be given a plausible defense.

One way to introduce this defense is with the following quote from

David Hume:

Hume's basic thought is that there is a big difference between free actions and actions which are random or chance.

Here's a thought experiment:

Now ask yourself: is Alex's choice free? It seems very clear that it is not. It is not up to Alex what he does; and free actions have to be up to the person doing the action.

This suggests:

If an act is free, then
the agent must control
whether it happens.

But now consider the idea that free will requires the falsity of determinism. If this is true, then it must be that free actions (or their immediate causes) are undetermined:

If Libertarianism is true,
then, if there are free
actions, those actions are
undetermined by anything
prior to the action.

After all, if free actions **could** be determined by the prior state of the world, then free will would be compatible with determinism. But we are assuming that it isn't.





1. No one has any choice about events which

future is not just what the state of the

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

then DECISION happens. (3)

varlatatie + the last of the

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

then DECISION. (4,5)

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

happened in the distant past.

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

about whether @.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

3. If determined, the only one

of interest.

theorie about the fact that if DNR

and none has any choice about whether,



4. If determinism is true, the laws of

choice principle, and determinism

This argument seems to show that the

combination of four - that No

choice about the laws of nature, then no

rules out free will.

one has any choice about the past, no



Since the first three of these theses

true, there are no free actions — and

seems to show that if determinism is

hence that free will is incompatible with

seem quite plausible, the argument



We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



The master argument against the reality of free will

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

defenses.

But, we'll see now, this argument can also be given a plausible

One way to introduce this defense is with the following quote from

David Hume:

Human's basic thought is that there is a big difference between free

actions and actions which are on chance.

Now ask yourself: is Alex's choice free? It seems very clear that it is

up to the person doing the action.

not. It is not up to Alex what he does; and free actions have to be



the agent must control

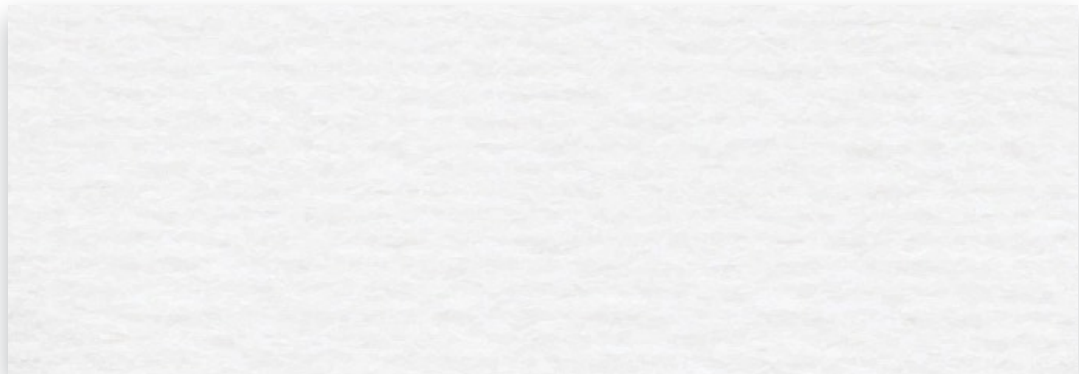
If area is free, then

what her [•]it happens.

But now consider the idea that free will requires the falsity of

determinism. If this is true, then it must be that free actions (or their

immediate causes) are undetermined:



then, if there are

undetermined by anything

If I inherit a million dollars, I will give it to charity.

prior to the action.

activities, those activities are

world, then free will would be compatible with determinism. But we

are assuming that it isn't.

After all, if free actions could be determined by the prior state of the

believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "against compatibilist free will" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will



The consequence argument

Randomizer, but it is random. It is not up to Alex what he does; and

freedoms have to be up to the person doing the action.

Now ask yourself: is Alex's choice free? It seems very clear that it is

not. It is undetermined by facts prior to the relevant run of the

harpers.

colorful



ifree, then the

width in inches

I f

ai

act

is

aberrant

invisant



If Libertarianism is true,
then, if there are free
actions, those actions are
undetermined by anything
prior to the action.

This suggests:

immediate cause) are undetermined:

But now consider the idea that free will requires the falsity of

determinism. If this is true, then it must be that free actions (or their

If Libertarianism is true,
then, if there are free
actions, those actions are
undetermined by anything
prior to the action.